As a result, their folders pertaining to conventional operations were rudimentary and outdated. In a way though, this was good as it forced us to do everything a priori for ourselves. We carried out our own analysis of the terrain and the deductions thereof, often coming up with new perspectives that had not been thought of earlier. We did not get templated by 'what is' but rather thought more along the lines of 'what should be'. Once again, this was not liked by the older formations as they thought we were trying to be extra smart and trying to show them in poor light. One of our recommendations was that 106 Inf Bde could take on the AOR hitherto assigned due to a lack of troops to an ad hoc brigade and do away with this ad hocism. This recommendation was not accepted then, but this change has been effected now. At the time of raising, the Corps Commander of 4 Corps was Lt Gen Gyan Bhushan, who was replaced by Lt Gen Shakti Gurung. (Maj) Gyan Bhushan had been the BM of 191 Infantry Brigade when we had been part of the same formation way back in 1983–86. He had seen me as a young Captain, always at the forefront of all activities. (Col) Shakti Gurung had himself been the DA, Myanmar, so we had that in common. Both were absolutely clear-headed when it came to operations and would not compromise operational effectiveness at the altar of turf battles. When the question of reorientation of the AOR of the Divisions came up, I was nominated to write a military paper analysing the pros and cons and to make recommendations. I was in a quandary, but I need not have worried. The Corps Commander called me and in private told me exactly how to word the paper and what should be the final recommendations. Write five points in favour of 5 Mountain Division and seven points in favour of 71 Infantry Division he said, and leave the rest to me. And that's how 71 Infantry Division got its own AOR, both in war and

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